

THE INTERNET OF THINGS



News, views and development on the Internet of Things



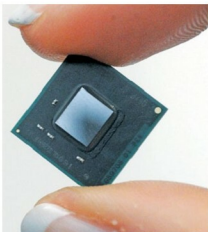
The IoT is on Everybody's Mind

The Internet of Things (IoT) appears to be one of the hottest topics in the IT world today and seems to be significantly influencing the strategies and plans of companies in varied segments ranging from mobile and data centre to systems security. Here is a collation of some recent strategy-related announcements from industry leaders that shows how much companies are betting on the IoT. In fact, at major events including the International CES and Mobile World Congress, people seemed to be talking about little else

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Intel Inside. For a long time, ARM has been (and continues to be) inside many a successful IoT devices, but now Intel is gearing up for the race. In February this year, Intel revealed an extended portfolio of computing and communication assets, focussed on building the IoT. "The continued growth of the mobile ecosystem depends on solving tough computing challenges—unlocking data's potential while securely and reliably connecting billions of devices with leading edge computing and communications technologies," said Intel President Renee James at the Mobile World Congress.

"Today we are announcing leading communications products as well as new computing platforms. As a result, Intel is well positioned to shape the future of mobile computing and the Internet of Things." Amongst the products on show at the event was Intel's 2.13GHz Atom processor Z3480 for Android smartphones and tablets, a 22-nanometre Silvermont micro-architecture based 64-bit ready SoC with Intel's new Integrated Sensor Solution, which efficiently manages sensor data to help devices remain smart and contextually-aware even in a low-power state.



Intel Quark SoC X1000—the first product from the Intel Quark technology family of low-power, small-core products. Intel Quark technology will extend Intel architecture into rapidly growing areas—from the Internet of Things to wearable computing in the future (Courtesy: Intel)

Intel also spoke about its upcoming 64-bit processor Moorefield and stronger LTE-Advanced capabilities in upcoming products. Some weeks later, Intel also introduced the Intel Gateway Solutions for IoT, a family of platforms based on Intel Quark and Atom processors, along with McAfee and Wind River software, for companies to seamlessly weave industrial devices into an IoT-ready system of systems.

McAfee, securing the IoT. According to IDC, the installed base of the Internet of Things will be around 212

billion 'things' globally by the end of 2020. Put differently, that is, approximately 27 things per person! While the myriad devices ranging from smartphones and mobile devices to industrial sensors provide a rich user experience and enhanced effectiveness, they also pose serious threats to privacy and security.

McAfee hopes to secure all these devices smoothly without hassling the users, while enabling them to perform effectively. Their strategy comprises several dimensions, including assurance that devices are operating as intended by the manufacturer and have not been corrupted; lifecycle security across the device, network and data centre; support for industry standards and device interoperability; ability to solve II/cloud services challenges in connecting legacy and new systems to new and future services; and technology to assure individual privacy. McAfee is working closely with Intel and Wind River in achieving this goal.

Cisco, enabling smartness. Speaking at their annual press event, Rob Lloyd, president of sales and development at Cisco mentioned that they see a \$14.4 trillion business opportunity in the IoT, with initial markets being manufacturing, government, energy and healthcare. The company is work-